CHAPTER FOUR / SIX TO NINE

A place for every piece

We will count, read, write and order six to nine.



Mr Aliyu: Aishatu has made a box game. Its paper pieces are all mixed.
Aishatu: I want to build the game now!
Grace: Let us make neat groups first.
Adamu: Everyone can take a turn to check.
John: Then we can put the groups in number order.

Our game needs four groups: six, seven, eight and nine pieces. We must sort, count and check before the game begins.

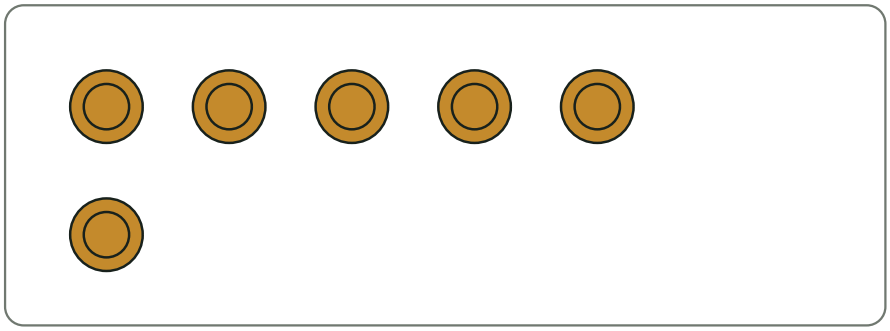
Read aloud. Use large, safe pieces at a reachable table.

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Five, then one more

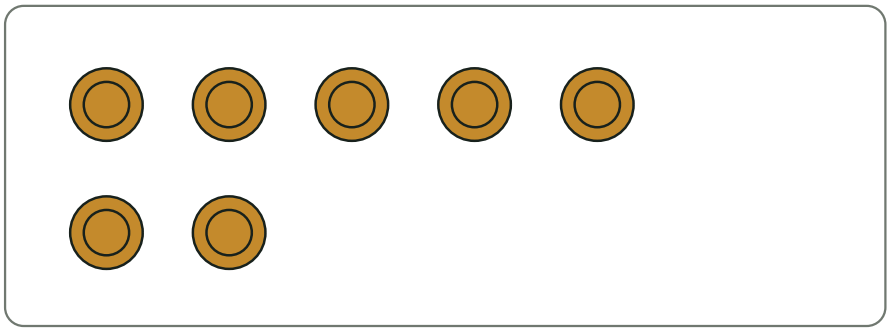
Watch Mr Aliyu move each top once. Count all the tops in each tray.

Mr Aliyu: Count the first five. Touch the next top and say six. Count them all to check.



6
six

Mr Aliyu: After six comes seven. This tray has five on the top row and two on the next row. Count all of them.



7
seven

Adamu: I will move one top each time I say a number.
Try together with six real counters. Then make seven.
Point to each new numeral and say its name.

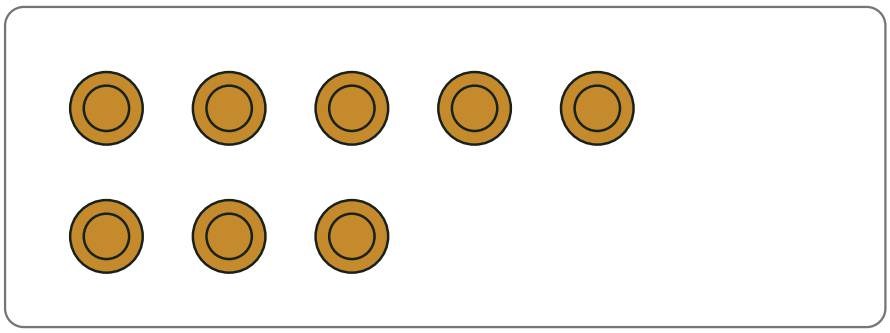
The last number word tells how many. Spreading a group out does not add tops.

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Count eight. Count nine.

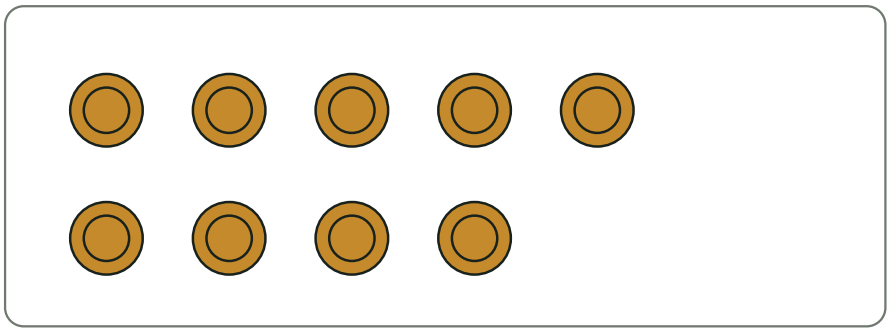
Touch each top once. Say how many. Read its numeral.

Mr Aliyu: After seven comes eight. Count the five tops, then the three on the next row. Check the whole group.



8
eight

Mr Aliyu: After eight comes nine. Count the five tops and the four on the next row. Check them all.



9
nine

John: Give me time to count before you tell me.
Try together: make eight real counters. Spread them out.
Count again. Make nine in another group and check.

Now an adult mixes cards 6, 7, 8, 9. Point to each card and say its number.

CHAPTER FOUR / SIX TO NINE

Watch the pencil move

Mr Aliyu writes each numeral on paper first. Watch, then air-write.

Mr Aliyu: These are four different numerals. Keep the top of your paper the same way up. Do not turn a 6 over to make a 9.

6

Start near the top. Curve down and around.
Close the loop at the bottom.

7

Start at the top left. Draw across to the right.
Slant down to the left.

8

Start near the top. Make a small loop,
then a lower loop. Join them neatly.

9

Make the loop at the top first.
Then draw the downstroke on the right.

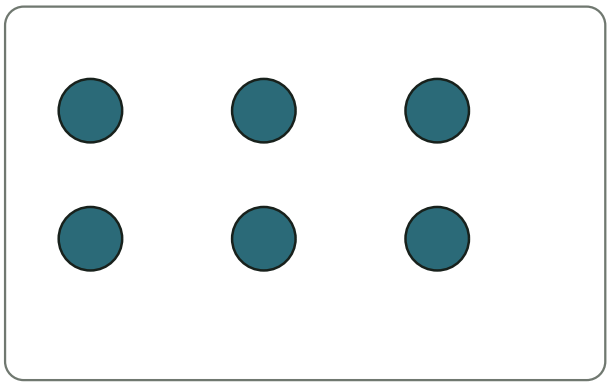
Grace: A smudge hid my loop. I can try again.
Trace, cover the model, then write on your own paper.
Workbook: Trace, cover and write.

CHAPTER FOUR / SIX TO NINE

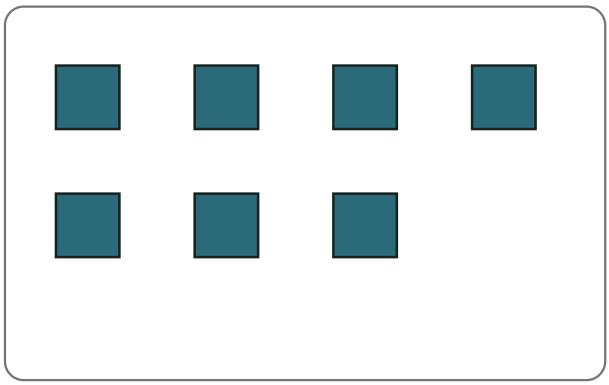
Same kind, same group

Watch sorting before you sort the real game pieces.

Mr Aliyu: I sort by shape. I put pieces with the same outline together. Here are two sorted groups. Count each group.



Six round pieces



Seven square pieces

Grace: I sort the other pieces by their outlines.
Aishatu: I can wait, then help count each group.
Try together: sort eight triangle pieces and nine rectangle pieces. Touch each piece once as you count.

Now sort on your own. An adult mixes all the game pieces. Make one group for each kind. Count each group.
Record the counts in your exercise book. You may draw one shape to label each group.
Workbook: Sort and record.

An adult supplies the real pieces. You do not need to know the shape names yet. Point to their outlines.

CHAPTER FOUR / SIX TO NINE

Put the groups in order

Use real counters as well as numeral cards.

Mr Aliyu: Compare groups of six and seven. Pair the counters. Seven has one left over, so six comes first. Add eight, then nine: each group has one more.

6 7 8 9

Before means earlier in counting order. After means later.
Six comes before seven. Nine comes after eight.

Adamu: I put eight before seven.
Grace: Let us count and pair those groups again.
Try together. Put the seven group between six and eight.

Your turn. Write in your exercise book.
Write the number after 6.
Write the number before 9.

Order: **9, 6, 8, 7**.
Put them from fewest to most. Use real groups if you need them.

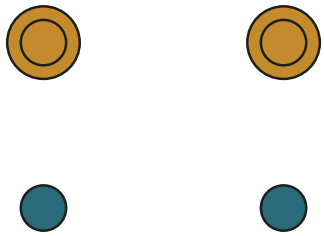
Check your order by counting each group.
Workbook: Before, after and order. Write your answers there instead if you have it.

CHAPTER FOUR / SIX TO NINE

Draw, count and check

Remember the method before looking back. Try on your own first.

Watch a drawing example. Mr Aliyu makes one dot for each of two counters. He counts both dots to check.



Draw 6 dots in your exercise book.
Count 9 real objects for a partner.
How can you check a set of 8? Tell or show a partner.

John: I will move each counted piece to another mat.
Show your partner how this stops you counting one twice.

Need help? With an adult, move five counters once each. Add one, then count all six. Recheck a fresh set of seven on your own.
For reading or writing, work on one numeral at a time. Cover the model before trying again.

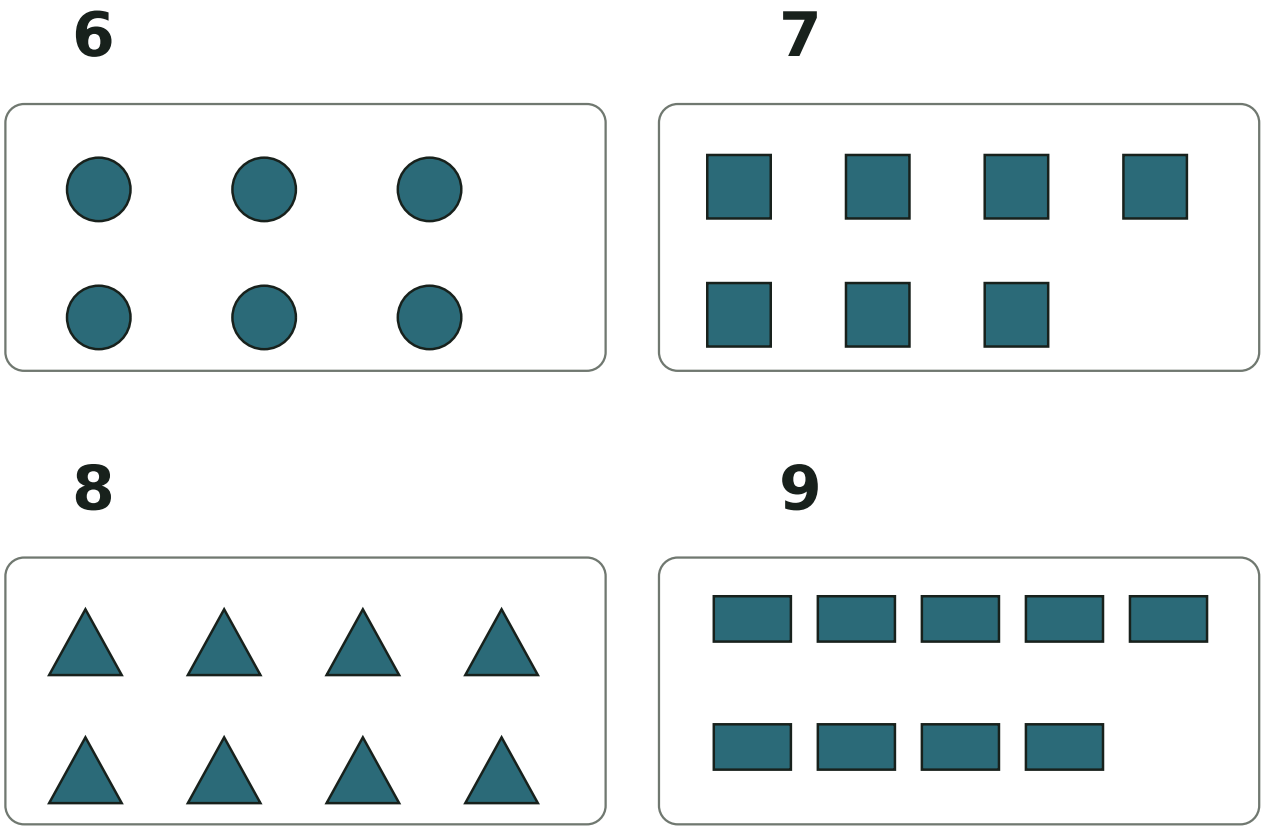
Workbook: Draw and count; Check eight. Use safe real counters as well.

CHAPTER FOUR / SIX TO NINE

Our box game is ready

Actually sort, count and arrange your four game groups before starting.

Aishatu: I have made a place for every kind.
Grace: I checked each group by moving pieces once.
Adamu: We all had a turn. Now the groups are in order.
John: Six, seven, eight, nine. The number puzzle is solved!



Mr Aliyu: Every piece has a group. Every group has the right count. Now your game can begin.

A fresh try. Ask an adult for new scattered groups to count, mixed numeral cards to read, and numbers to write without copying.
Use Workbook: A fresh number try, or an exercise book.

FOR THE TEACHER / SIX TO NINE

Teach, notice and return

Adult guidance / Several short sessions, not a race through four numerals.

Sequence. TB1 purpose; TB2-3 quantities six/seven then eight/nine, numeral names and one-to-one counting; TB4 live formation/air-writing; TB5 actual sorting; TB6 modelled quantity order and source tasks; TB7 drawing model, recall/support; TB8 actual sorting/counting/ordering resolution, then fresh checks. Do not advance before each quantity is secure. Existing introductions remain in the opening book.

Prepare. Reachable mats, large safe counters, paper/pencil and cards 1-9. For S002 prepare 6 blue circles, 7 red squares, 8 green triangles and 9 yellow non-square rectangles. Model sorting by outline; shape naming is not assessed. Printed pieces use one colour to show the outline rule. All 30 pieces stay in the same four story groups. Squares remain a special kind of rectangle; use the most specific names here.

Separate skills. Observe quantity, count-once method, recognition, independent naming, dictation/formation and order separately. Counting correctly does not prove reading; copying does not prove writing from dictation. For reversed 6 or 9, keep paper upright and watch the loop/downstroke. Accept usual communication and established adapted writing methods.

Support/recheck. Use counted/uncounted mats and five counters plus one. Model six, then independently check a new seven set. If sorting is hard, sort two small groups then rebuild the target groups. For numeral difficulty, air-write/trace one form, cover it, then dictate it; later retry a different order. Do not label a child as the weak counter.

Delayed recall, next session. Count fresh sets of 6, 7 and 8. Read shuffled cards 9, 6, 8, 7 independently. Dictate nine, seven, six, eight: 9, 7, 6, 8. Order 8, 6, 9: 6, 8, 9. Sort 7 tops and 9 leaves; state each count. Record which skills need support.

FOR THE TEACHER / SIX TO NINE

Answers and independent checks

Adult task map / TB = this textbook; WB = its paired workbook.

Source tasks. P1-04-Q1 (TB6/WB2): 7. Q2 (same): 8. Q3 (same): 6, 7, 8, 9. Q4 (TB7/WB3): exactly 6 separate dots, any clear arrangement. Q5 (same): exactly 9 real objects, each counted once; state 9. Q6 (TB7/WB4): recount 8 once per object; the last word is eight. Moving each counted object is valid. Check the method as well as the total.

Every model. TB2: 6 is five and one; 7 is five and two. TB3: 8 is five and three; 9 is five and four. Spreading changes no quantity. TB4/WB1: recognisable 6, 7, 8, 9; loop below for 6, above for 9. TB5: 6 round/7 square; guided 8 triangle/9 rectangle. TB6: pairing 6 and 7 leaves one unmatched in 7; seven goes between six and eight. Before/after mean earlier/later in counting order. TB7: 2 counters/2 dots; support 6, recheck 7. TB8: groups of 6, 7, 8, 9 in increasing row order.

S002 (TB5/WB5). Mix all 30 pieces. Sort by outline, count and record: 6 circles, 7 squares, 8 triangles, 9 non-square rectangles. Order: 6, 7, 8, 9. Observe actual sorting; written counts alone do not demonstrate it. For story closure (TB8), verify all 30 pieces in these groups before starting the pretend game.

Fresh checks (TB8/WB6). Privately prepare new scattered groups of 8 and 9; answers 8 and 9. S003: count 9 objects once each, then independently name ALL shuffled cards 1-9 without supplied names. Test recognition separately by naming 6, 7, 8, 9 in a different order. Cover all cards and earlier printed numerals. S004: dictate eight, six, nine, seven; answers 8, 6, 9, 7, correctly oriented. Do not show answers or read this rubric aloud while testing.

Same tasks on both surfaces count as one check. New physical objects, independently shuffled naming and covered-model dictation are fresh evidence. No tasks have been administered to pupils.

FOR THE TEACHER / SIX TO NINE

Words, evidence and credits

Chapter four continuation / Not a completed annual book.

Words. Six/seven/eight/nine: quantities after five. Count: say one number word per object. Numeral: written number symbol. Sort: group by a rule. Order: arrange from fewest to most here. Before/after: earlier/later in the counting sequence. Outline: the edge of a shape. Shape names may be read by an adult; they are sorting materials, not a new naming test.

Historical mapping. P1-p02-01: sorting/classifying quantities; -02: identify quantities; -03: count/read through 9; -04: write 6-9; -05: quantity order. Original P1-04-Q1-Q6 prompts, answers and order retained. S002 adds actual four-type sorting; S003 adds shuffled reading; S004 adds independent dictation. The historical baseline and suggested pacing do not establish current curriculum alignment.

Provenance. Reused fictional Mr Aliyu classroom image: artwork/redesign/scenes/mr-aliyu-blackboard-v1.png; original image_gen prompts/references in adjacent provenance and artwork/manifest.json. No new AI art. Tops, dots and shape pieces are deterministic vector drawings; never count decorative classroom art. Fonts: DejaVu Sans, fonts/LICENSE_DEJAVU.txt.

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Primary Two preview. Larger numbers, exchanging tens, equal groups and further measurement are planned. Revisit these foundations first. The final four offline-AI pupil pages and annual revision/assessment remain part of the planned full Primary One textbook, outside this extract.